

FrozenBrew Bars

Vanilla lattes, espresso, and matcha frozen into popsicles — coffee as a summer obsession.

What It Is

A frozen-coffee-bar business. Instead of another iced coffee, you freeze real espresso drinks — vanilla latte, straight espresso, matcha, mocha — into popsicle-style bars people eat like ice cream. It feels new, refreshing, and perfect for hot days, and unlike a single café you can mass-produce and sell the bars through many channels.

How It Makes Money

Two stacked models: (1) sell bars direct at a cart, kiosk, café, or market stall at high per-unit margin, and (2) wholesale packaged bars to supermarkets, convenience stores, coffee shops, hotels, festivals, and food trucks. The drink stays familiar; the frozen format opens a whole new market and price point.

Startup Costs

- Commercial popsicle/ice-pop molds + blast freezer or chest freezers (Alibaba: "commercial popsicle mold machine" / "ice pop production machine"): \$1,500–\$8,000
- Ingredients (espresso/coffee, milk/cream, matcha, sweetener, sticks): \$0.40–\$0.90 per bar
- Compostable wrappers/packaging with label: \$0.10–\$0.25 per bar
- Cottage-food or commercial kitchen + food permits: \$500–\$2,000
- Display freezer for cart/retail: \$400–\$1,500 (used)
- Branding, packaging design, photography, simple site: \$600–\$1,500
- First-month market fees / ads: \$300–\$800
- **Total to launch: \$4,000–\$14,000** (start lean with chest freezers + manual molds)

The Numbers

- Cost per bar (ingredients + wrapper): \$0.60–\$1.10
- Direct sell price (cart/market): \$4–\$6
- Wholesale price (stores): \$2.20–\$3.00
- Profit per bar: direct \$3–\$5; wholesale \$1.30–\$2.00
- Sell 200–350 bars/day at markets/cart in season + wholesale 5,000 bars/month → **\$12,000–\$28,000 revenue, \$8,000–\$18,000 profit/month** in peak summer.

How To Start

1. Develop 4–6 signature flavors (vanilla latte, mocha, matcha, cold brew, caramel) that freeze well without going icy.
2. Get a cottage-food permit or rent a commercial kitchen with freezer capacity.
3. Buy molds and freezing equipment; nail texture so bars are creamy, not crystallized (add a little cream/stabilizer).
4. Design clean, photogenic packaging and a brand that reads premium-café, not cheap-popsicle.
5. Launch direct at farmers' markets, a cart, or a café collab to test flavors and gather content.
6. Shoot reels of the frozen-coffee bite — the format is inherently shareable.
7. Build a wholesale line sheet and pitch local cafés, grocers, hotels, and festival organizers.

Where To Get Customers

Farmers' markets, fairs, and festivals (direct, high margin); café and hotel collabs; wholesale to grocers, convenience stores, and gyms; food trucks and events; Instagram/TikTok summer content; corporate and event catering for hot-weather functions.

Pro Tips

- Beat the iciness problem early — a touch of cream, stabilizer, or higher fat keeps bars smooth; a crystallized first batch sinks the brand.
- Season is your friend and enemy: pre-sell wholesale before summer and bank cash for the slow months, or add a hot-coffee or indoor line.
- Wholesale is where it scales — one supermarket chain order dwarfs a season of market stalls, so package and label retail-ready from day one.